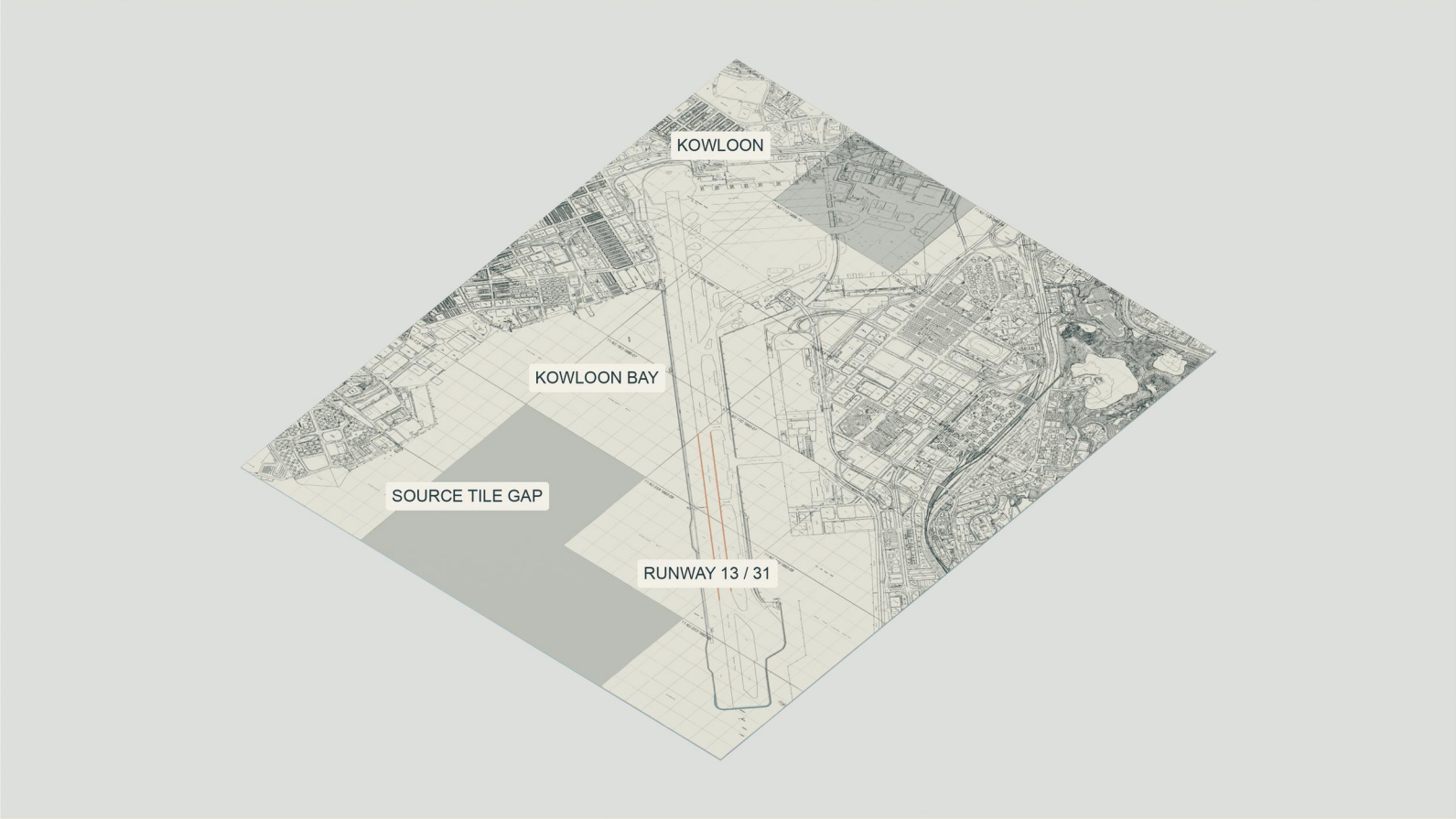
A runway inside the city

Kai Tak and Kowloon, read through the historical survey archive



Survey editions, 1986–1993

EVIDENCE-LED

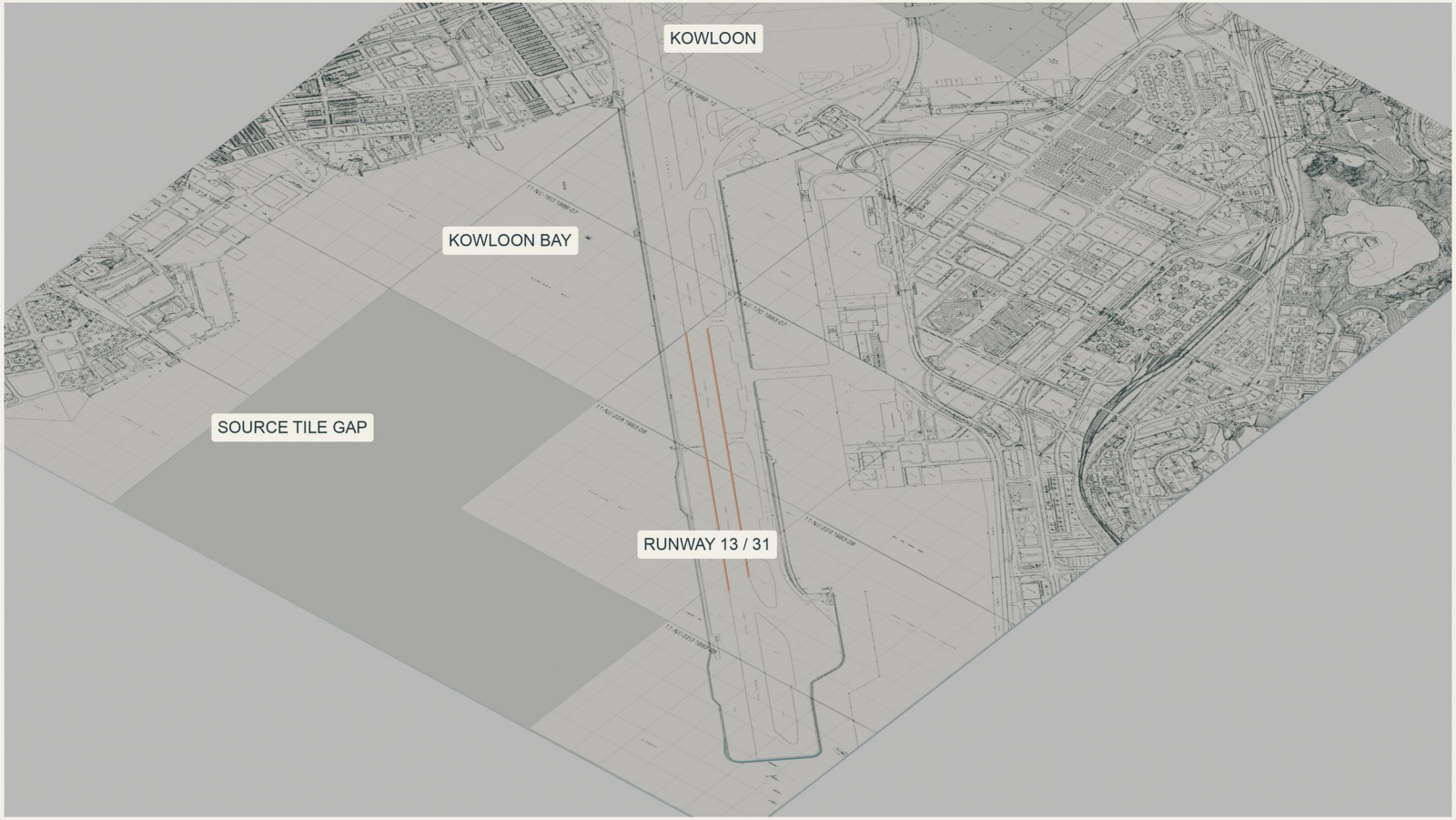
The historical survey sheets place the long airport peninsula beside the urban fabric of Kowloon. Their different editions remain visible; they do not form a single-date city survey.

Bounded cartographic alternative: no complete historical terrain, coastline vector or calibrated city model. Flat map board is not terrain.

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The runway into the bay

A mapped peninsula, with the surviving seawall evidence highlighted



Survey editions, 1986–1993

EVIDENCE-LED

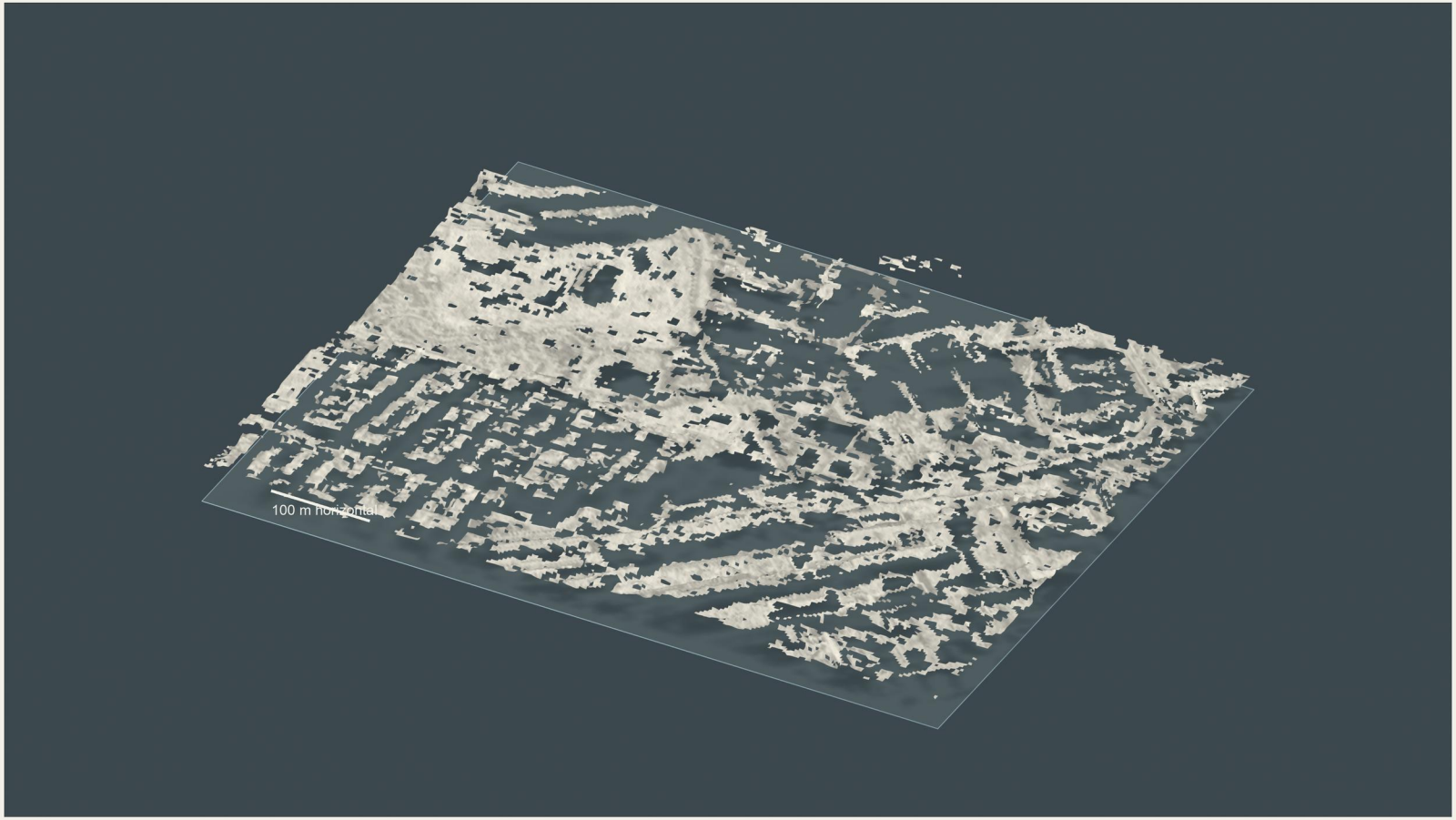
The map records the runway projecting into Kowloon Bay. Highlighted linework is the actually digitized evidence, not a completed shoreline. Published landing distance available is 2,786 m; it is not the runway's total physical length.

Only partial runway edges and the August 1993 southeastern seawall are traced. Shoreline completion, water height and exact threshold registration remain unresolved.

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The city beneath the aircraft

An elevated virtual view of the observed Kowloon surface



Photographs: 2 November 1993

EVIDENCE-LED

Two overlapping photographs recover a broken relief of the city. The gaps are retained: the archive does not support complete walls, roofs or historical building solids here.

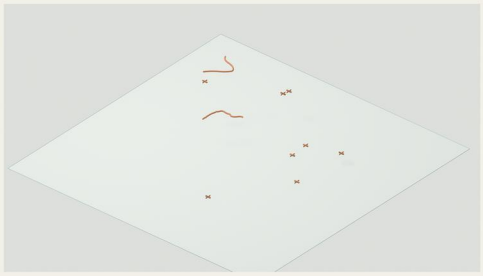
A small observed patch, not all Kowloon. Surfaces include roofs, ground, vegetation and possible mismatches; holes mean missing observations.

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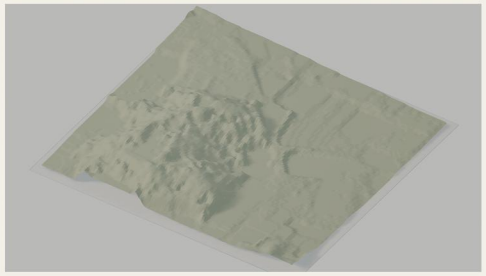
Reading Checkerboard Hill

Actual historical height observations and a separately dated modern terrain view

1989 · MAPPED HEIGHTS



2014–2015 · TERRAIN



GEOGRAPHIC RELATIONSHIP



No inferred track. Land surface and painted checkerboard position unresolved.

Historical observations and later terrain are separate panels. The location diagram identifies the hill region, not a surveyed position of the painted board.

Hill observations: November 1989 / terrain context: 2014–2015

INTERPRETIVE / DISCLOSED CONTEXT

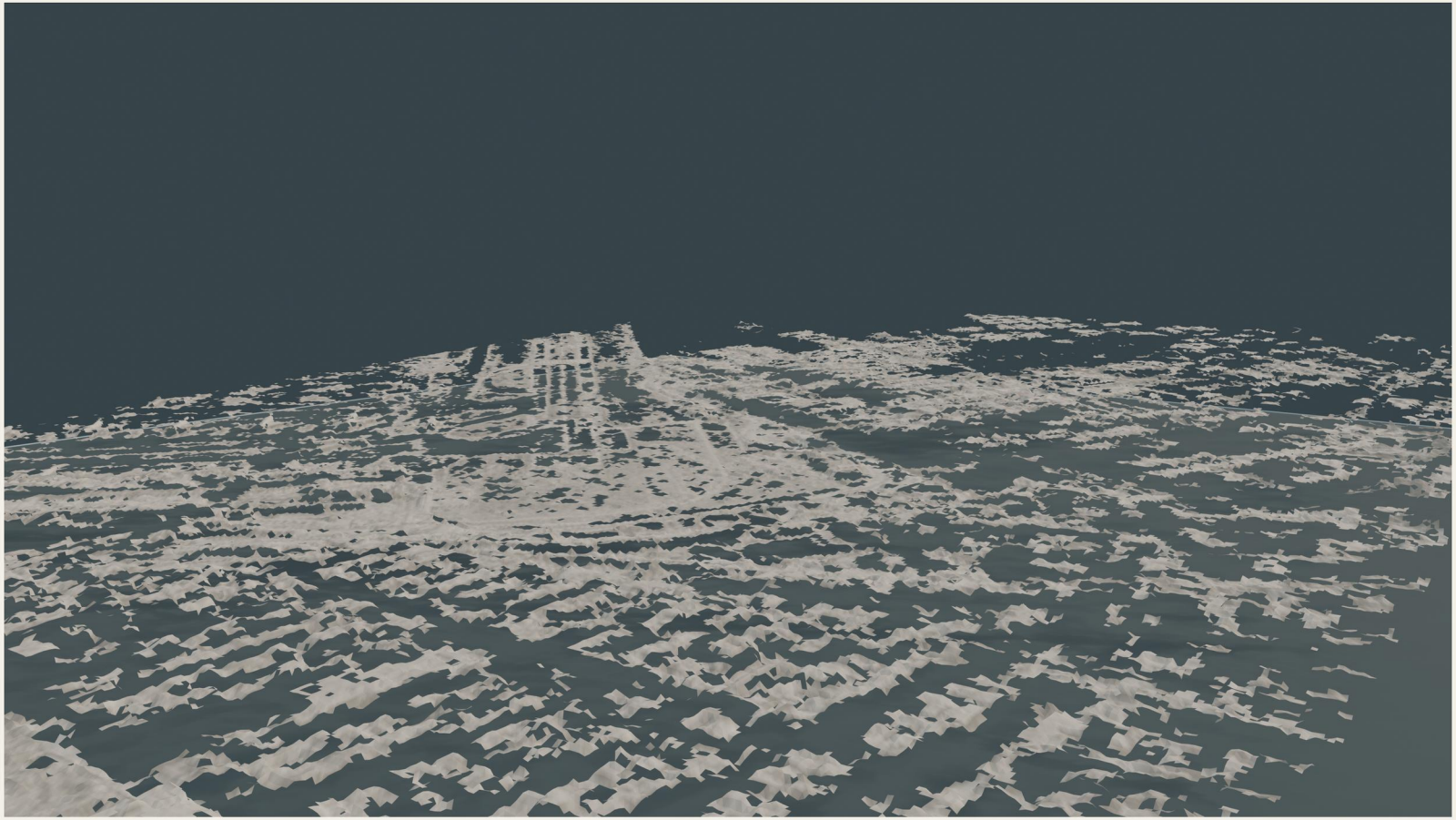
The surviving hill observations rise from 31.4 to 80 m above Hong Kong Principal Datum. They are evidence of local terrain, not a complete hill model. The checkerboard helped pilots recognize the visual turn toward the airport.

Eight mapped spot heights and two partial contours do not define the full hill. The painted board's exact surveyed position and face geometry are unavailable. No flown approach arc is asserted.

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Looking through the approach area

An illustrative virtual perspective, not a recovered cockpit view



Surface: 2 November 1993; camera: illustrative

INTERPRETIVE / DISCLOSED CONTEXT

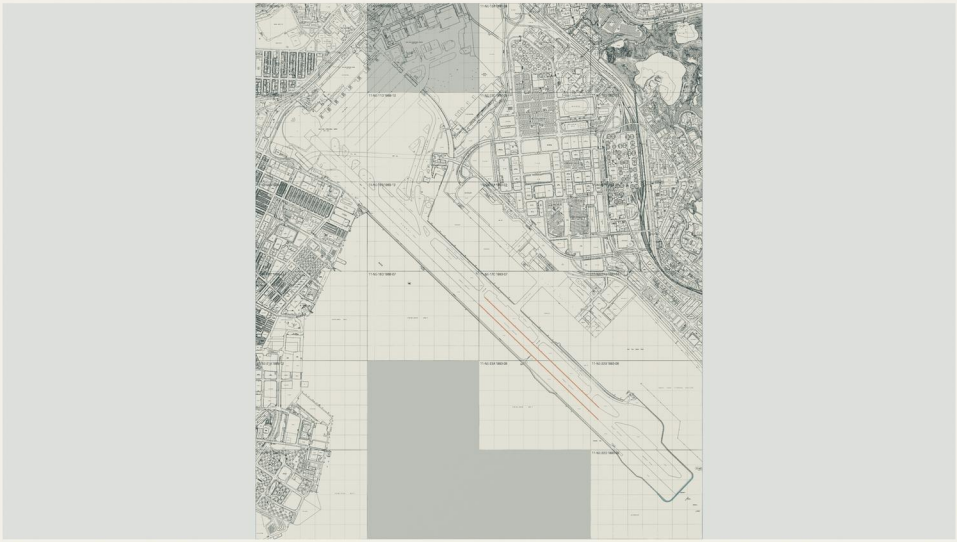
The camera is a documented artistic viewpoint over the observed surface. It conveys local visual complexity, not what a particular pilot saw. The historical final turn required visual references; this image makes no zero-visibility claim.

Evidence-limited alternative: runway and complete approach terrain are outside this surface reconstruction. No aircraft position, historical field of view, cockpit or flight path is reconstructed.

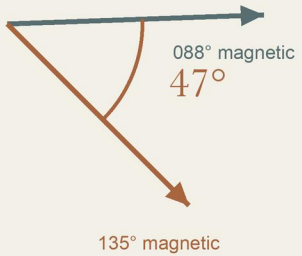
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Forty-seven degrees

The difference between published inbound and runway magnetic courses



A change of direction



Schematic only. These arrows use magnetic north; the adjacent map uses grid north. No geographical flight path is drawn.

Historical procedure reference; maps: 1986–1993

INTERPRETIVE / DISCLOSED CONTEXT

The nominal course difference is 47°. Turning an aircraft between those directions takes space, time and visual reference. These arrows compare directions only; they are not a historical track or the research model's trajectory.

088° and 135° are magnetic courses. The adjacent diagram is schematic and is not aligned to the map's grid north. The mapped runway edge is about 134.02° GRID.

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Kowloon, October 1989

Reviewed historical faces on their original survey-sheet context



Survey edition: October 1989

EVIDENCE-LED

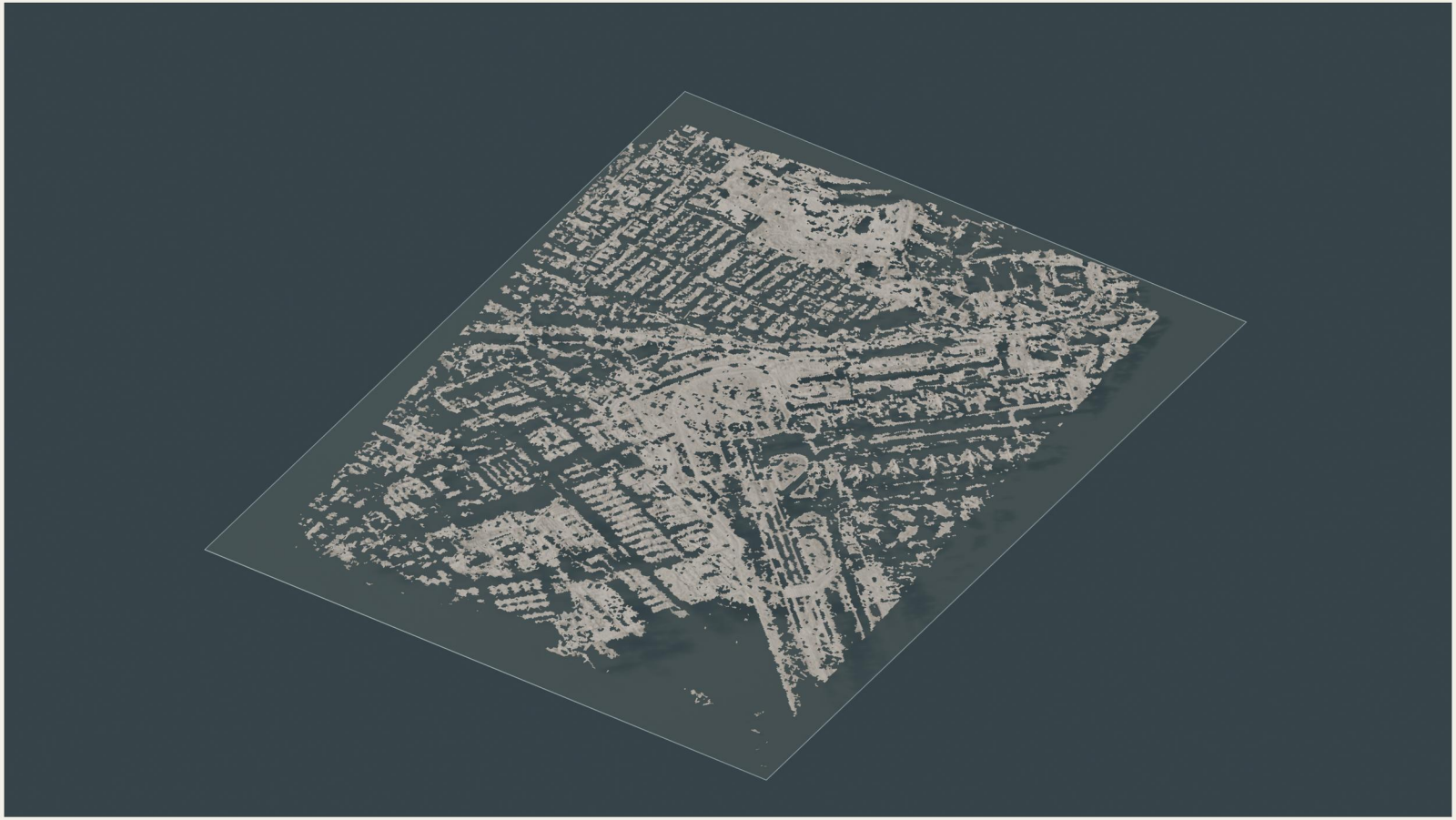
The highlighted mapped faces are supported by the inspected sheet. They stay flat because the archive does not establish their heights. The map's many other symbols are not automatically accepted building footprints.

15 reviewed mapped forms, not a complete building census. Their physical heights remain unknown. Map edition is not a construction or presence date.

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November 1993, in fragments

The actual observed-surface reconstruction, rendered without invented walls



Photographs: 2 November 1993

EVIDENCE-LED

A36142 and A36143 supply the image observations. The original mesh keeps unsupported holes and uses no generated architecture. Warm lighting is an artistic choice, not evidence of weather on the photographic date.

225,371 original triangles; nominal camera calibration. Heights are relative to a fitted park/road plane, not HKPD. Only 3,780 of 171,307 dense points lie inside the local map-control hull.

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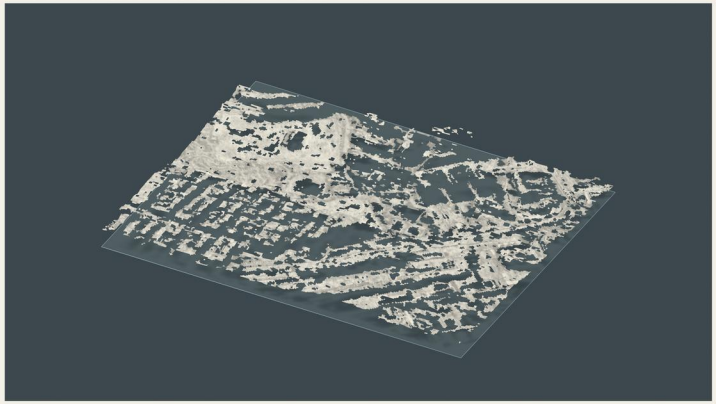
Three editions, one place

1989, 1994 and 1997 maps, with a separately dated 1993 photo-derived view

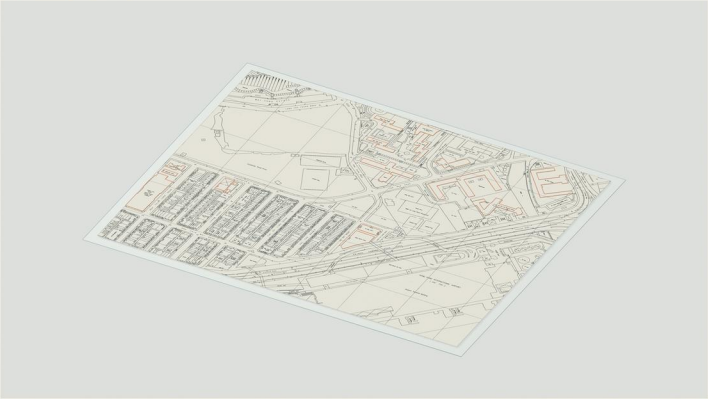
OCTOBER 1989 · MAP



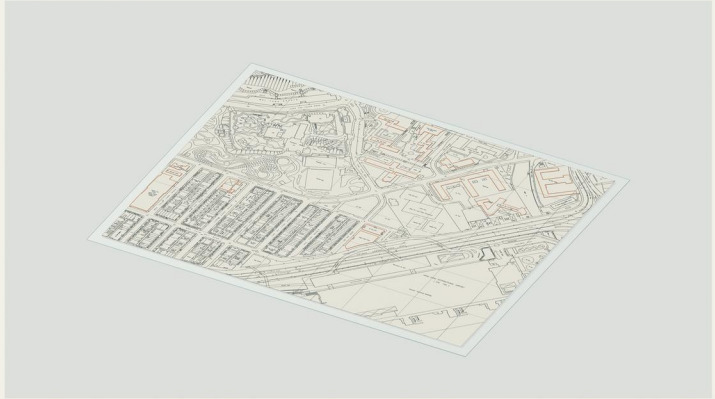
NOVEMBER 1993 · PARTIAL SURFACE



JULY 1994 · MAP



APRIL 1997 · MAP



1989 / 1993 / 1994 / 1997

EVIDENCE-LED

The same view makes changes in documentary content inspectable. Unequal detail is preserved: map ink, reviewed faces and photograph-derived surfaces are different kinds of evidence.

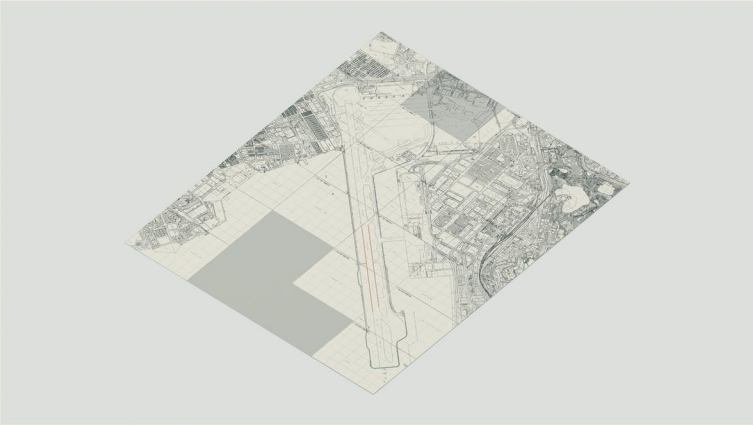
All panels share horizontal camera and extent. The stereo panel has relative Z; maps are flat documentary layers. No precise construction or demolition dates follow from edition differences.

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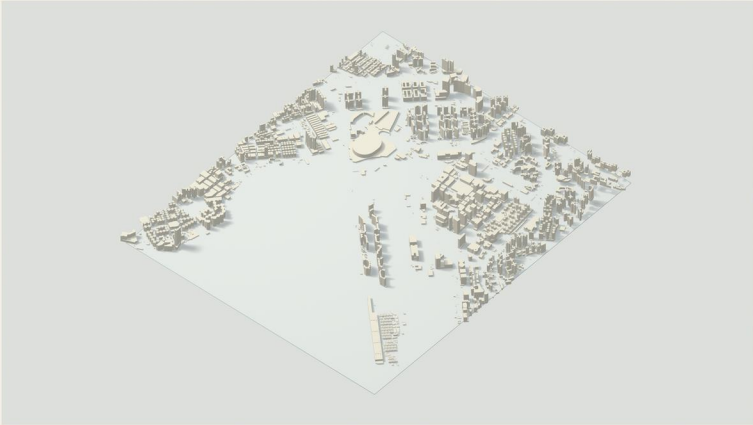
The airport landscape, then and now

Historical map evidence and the September 2026 building inventory

1986–1993 · DOCUMENTED AIRPORT



SEPTEMBER 2026 · CURRENT BUILDINGS



Historical maps: 1986–1993 / buildings: 21 September 2026

EVIDENCE-LED

The right panel shows current-source building geometry, including development in the former airport area. The old airport is not depicted as operational in 2026. Cameras match horizontally; source epochs and vertical meanings remain separate.

Modern solids use approximate HKPD base/top elevations; missing or invalid records are omitted explicitly. Flat historical maps are not a 1993 solid city. No terrain surface is shown; the available DTM derives from 2014–2015 photographs.

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From photograph to spatial evidence

One source image, its linked surface, and the geographic interpretation

01 THE PHOTOGRAPH



A36143 · rotated toward north, not an orthophoto

02 THE OBSERVED SURFACE



Same source tracks · 1993 relative-height mesh

03 THE MAP CONTEXT



October 1989 map · geographic positions

1 North market roof 2 Carpenter Road ground track 3 South market roof

Photo and surface: 2 November 1993 / map: October 1989

EVIDENCE-LED

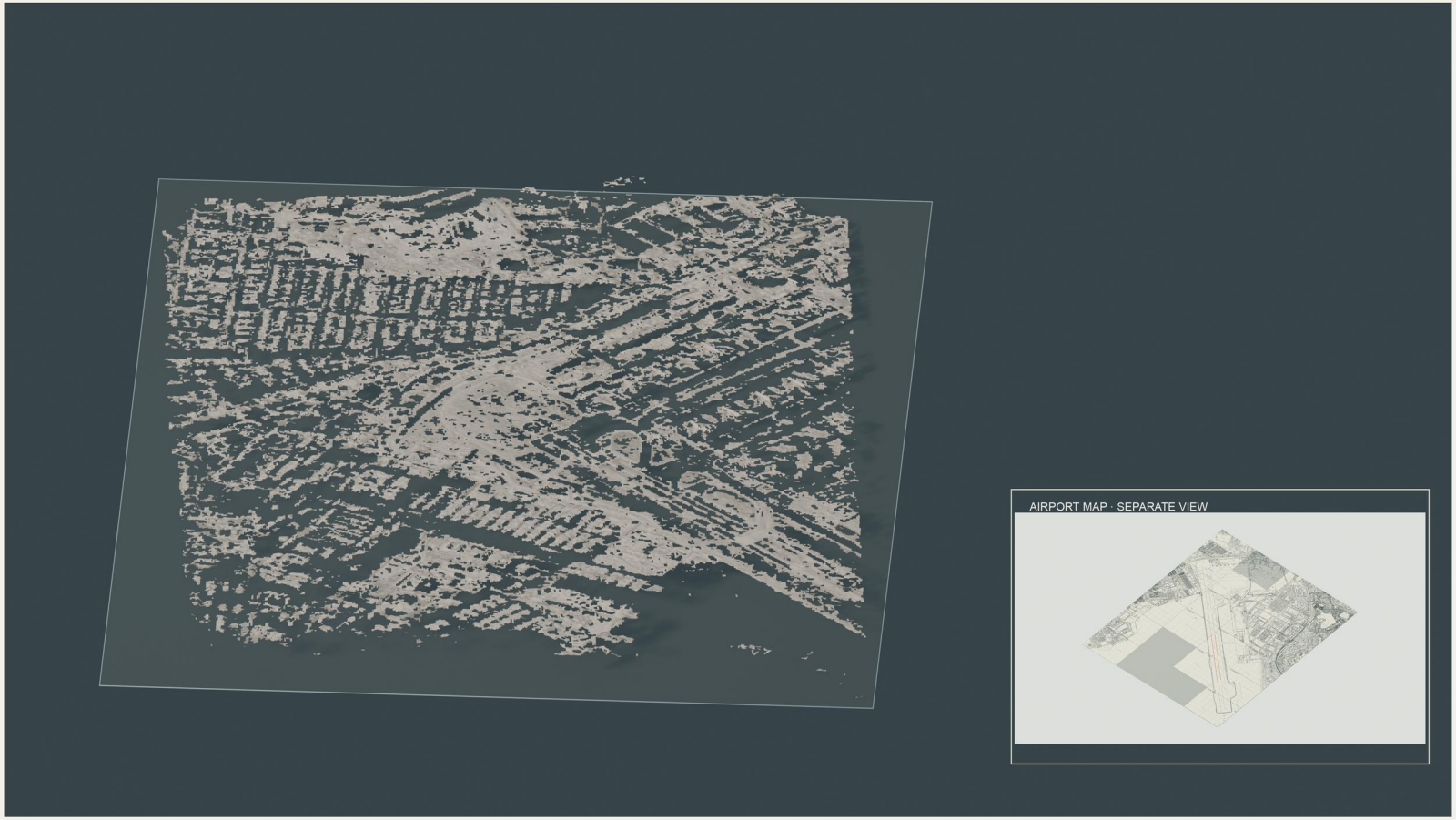
Numbered features connect original A36143 pixels to measured stereo tracks and their geographic positions. The map is a different dated source. Agreement of these panels is traceability, not an independent accuracy certificate.

The photograph is rotated toward north for reading, not orthorectified. Numbered points are actual same-source correspondences. Nominal calibration, parallax and local alignment uncertainty remain.

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Checkers with Runway 13

A city, an airport, and the limits of what the archive lets us recover



1993 photo surface / historical maps, 1986–1993

INTERPRETIVE / DISCLOSED CONTEXT

The reconstructed city appears as an incomplete relief beside the historical airport geography. Together they show why this place invites investigation, while leaving the unknown architecture visibly unresolved.

The photographic panorama and airport map are separate views, not a seamless calibrated terrain/city model. The geographic inset supplies context; missing areas do not mean empty Hong Kong.

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